

Zijian Liu

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📄 Zijian Liu

Education

- Sept. 2022 **Department of Technology, Operations, and Statistics, New York University, NY**
– Jan. 2027 Ph.D. Candidate in Operations Research, advisor: Zhengyuan Zhou
(or May 2027)
- Sept. 2019 **Courant Institute of Mathematical Sciences, New York University, NY**
– May 2021 M.S. in Computer Science
- Sept. 2015 **School of Computer Science, Wuhan University, Wuhan, China**
– June 2019 B.Eng. in Software Engineering

Experience

- May 2026 **Thomas J. Watson Research Center, IBM Research, NY**
– Aug. 2026 Research Internship

Research Interests

Optimization, Sampling, Theoretical Machine Learning

Publications & Manuscripts

(* indicates equal contribution, † indicates alphabetical order)

- NeurIPS 2026 **In-Expectation Convergence of Stochastic Gradient Methods under Heavy-Tailed Noise**
(To Appear) Zijian Liu
[arXiv]
- NeurIPS 2026 **On the Last-Iterate Convergence of Clipped Gradient Methods**
(To Appear) Zijian Liu
[Available upon Request]
- COLT 2026 **Random Reshuffling Dominates Stochastic Gradient Descent**
Zijian Liu
[arXiv][Proceedings][Extended version available below]
- ICML 2026 **Can Adaptive Gradient Methods Converge under Heavy-Tailed Noise? A Case Study of AdaGrad**
Zijian Liu
[arXiv][OpenReview]
- ICLR 2026 **Clipped Gradient Methods for Nonsmooth Convex Optimization under Heavy-Tailed Noise: A Refined Analysis**
Zijian Liu
[arXiv (Full Version)][OpenReview][Proceedings]
- ALT 2026 **Online Convex Optimization with Heavy Tails: Old Algorithms, New Regrets, and Applications**
Zijian Liu
[arXiv (Full Version)][OpenReview][Proceedings]

ICML 2025 **Improved Last-Iterate Convergence of Shuffling Gradient Methods for Nonsmooth Convex Optimization**
Zijian Liu, Zhengyuan Zhou
[\[arXiv\]](#)[\[OpenReview\]](#)[\[Proceedings\]](#)

ICLR 2025 **Nonconvex Stochastic Optimization under Heavy-Tailed Noises: Optimal Convergence without Gradient Clipping**
Zijian Liu, Zhengyuan Zhou
[\[arXiv\]](#)[\[OpenReview\]](#)[\[Proceedings\]](#)

ICML 2024 **On the Last-Iterate Convergence of Shuffling Gradient Methods**
(Oral) Zijian Liu, Zhengyuan Zhou
[\[arXiv\]](#)[\[OpenReview\]](#)[\[Proceedings\]](#)

ICML 2024 **On the Convergence of Projected Bures-Wasserstein Gradient Descent under Euclidean Strong Convexity**
Junyi Fan*, Yuxuan Han*, Zijian Liu, Jian-Feng Cai, Yang Wang, Zhengyuan Zhou
[\[OpenReview\]](#)[\[Proceedings\]](#)

ICLR 2024 **Revisiting the Last-Iterate Convergence of Stochastic Gradient Methods**
Zijian Liu, Zhengyuan Zhou
[\[arXiv \(Full Version\)\]](#)[\[OpenReview\]](#)[\[Proceedings\]](#)

COLT 2023 **Breaking the Lower Bound with (Little) Structure: Acceleration in Non-Convex Stochastic Optimization with Heavy-Tailed Noise**
Zijian Liu, Jiawei Zhang, Zhengyuan Zhou
[\[arXiv\]](#)[\[Proceedings\]](#)

ICML 2023 **High Probability Convergence of Stochastic Gradient Methods**
Zijian Liu*, Ta Duy Nguyen*, Thien Hang Nguyen*, Alina Ene, Huy L. Nguyen
[\[arXiv \(Full Version\)\]](#)[\[OpenReview\]](#)[\[Proceedings\]](#)

ICLR 2023 **On the Convergence of AdaGrad(Norm) on $\mathbb{R}^d$: Beyond Convexity, Non-Asymptotic Rate and Acceleration**
Zijian Liu*, Ta Duy Nguyen*, Alina Ene, Huy L. Nguyen
[\[arXiv\]](#)[\[OpenReview\]](#)

ICML 2022 **Adaptive Accelerated (Extra-)Gradient Methods with Variance Reduction**
Zijian Liu*, Ta Duy Nguyen*, Alina Ene, Huy L. Nguyen
[\[arXiv\]](#)[\[Proceedings\]](#)

ICML 2022 **Distributionally Robust Q -Learning**
Zijian Liu, Qinxun Bai, Jose Blanchet, Perry Dong, Wei Xu, Zhengqing Zhou, Zhengyuan Zhou
[\[Proceedings\]](#)

Operations Research
Major Revision **Product Return as a Sequence of Search Processes: Optimality and Search Duration**
Xiaoyu Fan[†], Srikanth Jagabathula[†], Zijian Liu[†], Eitan Muller[†]
[\[Available upon Request\]](#)

In Submission **Improved Analysis of Stein Variational Gradient Descent**
Zijian Liu, Soumyadip Ghosh, Yingdong Lu, Tomasz Nowicki
[\[Available upon Request\]](#)

In Submission **Adam Converges in Nonsmooth Nonconvex Optimization**
Zijian Liu
[\[arXiv\]](#)

Preprint **Random Reshuffling for Smooth Convex Optimization: Dominates Stochastic Gradient Descent**
Zijian Liu
[\[Optimization Online\]](#)[\[Extended version of the COLT 2026 paper\]](#)

Preprint **Near-Optimal Non-Convex Stochastic Optimization under Generalized Smoothness**
Zijian Liu, Srikanth Jagabathula, Zhengyuan Zhou
[\[arXiv\]](#)

Preprint **Stochastic Nonsmooth Convex Optimization with Heavy-Tailed Noises: High-Probability Bound, In-Expectation Rate and Initial Distance Adaptation**
Zijian Liu, Zhengyuan Zhou
[\[arXiv\]](#)

Preprint **META-STORM: Generalized Fully-Adaptive Variance Reduced SGD for Unbounded Functions**
Zijian Liu*, Ta Duy Nguyen*, Thien Hang Nguyen*, Alina Ene, Huy L. Nguyen
[\[arXiv\]](#)

Talks

Jul. 2024 *25th International Symposium on Mathematical Programming*
Jul. 2024 *41st International Conference on Machine Learning*
Feb. 2026 *37th International Conference on Algorithmic Learning Theory*
Mar. 2026 *2026 INFORMS Optimization Society Conference*
Apr. 2026 *Thomas J. Watson Research Center, IBM Research*
June 2026 *39th Annual Conference on Learning Theory*

Services

Conference *ICML 2022, 2024, 2025, 2026 (Gold Reviewer)*
Reviewer *NeurIPS 2024, 2025, 2026*
ICLR 2025, 2026
ALT 2025, 2026
SODA 2026

Journal *IEEE Journal on Selected Areas in Information Theory (JSAIT)*
Reviewer *IEEE Transactions on Automatic Control (TAC)*
IEEE Transactions on Control Systems Technology (TCST)
IEEE Transactions on Signal Processing (TSP)
Journal of Machine Learning Research (JMLR)
Journal of Optimization Theory and Applications (JOTA)
Management Science
Mathematical Finance
SIAM Journal on Optimization (SIOPT)
Statistica Sinica

Organizer *MOILS seminar (internal seminar series at NYU Stern) Spring 2023*

Teaching Experience

(**U** denotes undergraduate-level courses, **G** denotes graduate-level courses)

Summer 2025	Operations Management (U) , Instructor Class Size: 15	New York University
Fall 2024	Operations Management (U) , Teaching Fellow Instructor: Prof. Divya Singhvi	New York University
Summer 2024	Stochastic Modeling & Simulation (U) , Teaching Fellow Instructor: Prof. Joshua Reed	New York University
Fall 2020	Bayesian Machine Learning (G) , Section Leader Instructor: Prof. Andrew Gordon Wilson	New York University